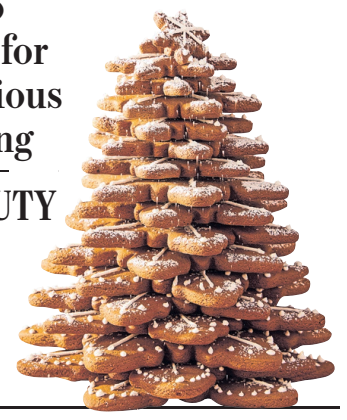
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WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



DOW JONES | News Corp ******** SATURDAY/SUNDAY, DECEMBER 6 - 7, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 134 WSJ.com ★★★★ $6.00

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Netflix agreed to buy** Warner Bros. for $72 billion after the entertainment company splits its studios and HBO Max streaming business from its cable networks. **A1, A6, B3**

◆ **SpaceX kicked off** a secondary share sale that would value the rocket maker at $800 billion to make it the most valuable U.S. private company. **A1**

◆ **The European Union** fined Elon Musk's X platform about $140 million for what it sees as breaches of the bloc's landmark digital-content law. **B10**

◆ **U.S. stocks finished** the week near records, lifted by investors' expectations that the Fed will lower interest rates next week. **B11**

◆ **Copper prices climbed** to a record, driven by fears of a global supply shortage and anticipation of a rate cut. **B11**

◆ **U.S. regulators rolled back** rules that limit how much risk banks can take in corporate lending, strictures that fueled the boom in the private credit industry. **B11**

◆ **The New York Times** sued Perplexity for copyright infringement, expanding its legal fight against artificial intelligence companies that it says steal and then profit from its content. **B10**

World-Wide

◆ **The latest annual** U.S. strategy document portrays European nations as wayward declining powers led by governments that suppress democracy and muzzle voices that want a more nationalistic turn. **A1**

◆ **A key vaccine panel** at the CDC voted 8-3 to quash a recommendation that all newborns be given a first dose of hepatitis B vaccine. **A1**

◆ **The Supreme Court** will decide if Trump can end the practice of granting citizenship to children born in the U.S., setting up a potential landmark showdown over one of the president's signature policy priorities. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge ordered** the release of grand-jury transcripts from the Justice Department's investigation into Jeffrey Epstein in Florida. **A3**

◆ **The United Arab** Emirates, paid more than $20 million to secure the freedom of an Emirati prince kidnapped by al Qaeda's West African affiliate, Western officials said. **A7**

◆ **Eurovision 2026 was** stirred up after several European countries said they would boycott the song contest because Israel was allowed to participate despite the war in Gaza. **A7**

◆ **Died: Frank Gehry**, 96, world-renowned architect. **C6**

NOONAN
We're in an era of political violence **A13**

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Netflix Sets Deal for Warner Bros.

Acquisition by streaming giant will cost $72 billion, faces antitrust concerns

By Joe Flint And Lauren Thomas

Netflix has agreed to buy Warner Bros. for $72 billion after the entertainment company splits its studios and HBO Max streaming business from its cable networks, a deal that would reshape the entertainment and media industry.

The cash-and-stock transaction was announced Friday after the two sides entered into exclusive negotiations for the media company known for Superman and the Harry Potter movies, as well as hit TV shows such as "Friends."

The offer is valued at $27.75 per Warner Bros. Discovery share and has an enterprise value of roughly $82.7 billion. Rival Paramount Skydance, which sought to buy the entire company, including Warner's cable networks, bid $30 per share all-cash for Warner Discovery, according to people familiar with the matter. Paramount is weighing its next move, which could involve pivoting to other potential acquisitions, people familiar with its plans said.

Paramount had argued that a deal with Netflix wouldn't be blessed by antitrust regulators given it would further cement the streamer's global dominance. President Trump's advisers, including White House officials, are concerned about the deal, a senior administration official said Friday.

Netflix's deal will have to contend with the preferences of Trump, who is close with Paramount Chief Executive David Ellison and his father and could pressure antitrust enforcers to steer Warner toward Paramount instead.

Netflix Co-Chief Executive Ted Sarandos said the company is "highly confident" about approval because it is "pro-consumer" and "pro-innovation."

Netflix's deal with Warner would combine the largest global streaming service with

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◆ **Antitrust review, Trump scrutiny are hurdles..... A6**
◆ **Warner Bros. CEO is having the last laugh..... B3**

Ahead of Soccer's World Cup, Trump Gets a Prize



JIM WATSON/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

GOLDEN GOAL: FIFA chief Gianni Infantino presented President Trump, who has coveted a Nobel Peace Prize, with the soccer governing body's first peace award at a ceremony Friday to set the group stage for next year's tournament in North America. **A10**

U.S. Flips History In Casting Europe As Threat

BRUSSELS—For years, the U.S. government has published an annual National Security Strategy that lays out how Washington sees the world and its approach to dealing with looming threats, from China to Russia to drug-traffickers in Latin America.

*By **Daniel Michaels**, **David Luhnow** and **Max Colchester***

This past week, the Trump administration's version seemed to reserve its harshest tone for a new target: America's closest allies in Europe.

The 30-page document painted European nations as wayward, declining powers that have ceded their sovereignty to the European Union and are led by governments that suppress democracy and muzzle voices that want a more nationalistic turn.

It says the continent faces "civilizational erasure"

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SpaceX Valuation Poised to Top OpenAI

SpaceX is kicking off a secondary share sale that would value the rocket maker at $800 billion, people familiar with the matter said, surpassing OpenAI to make it the most valuable U.S. private company.

*By **Berber Jin**, **Corrie Driebusch** and **Micah Maidenberg***

The company's chief financial officer, Bret Johnsen, told investors about the sale in recent days, and SpaceX executives have also said the company is weighing a potential initial public offering in 2026, some of the people said.

The $800 billion valuation is double the $400 billion value it fetched in a recent secondary share sale.

SpaceX didn't respond to a request for comment.

SpaceX investors have been waiting for an IPO for years as the company has grown into an essential service for the U.S. government, launching satellites and astronauts. It is also a provider of broadband internet around the world, used in remote areas ranging from the mountains of the U.S. to the frontiers of the war in Ukraine.

The IPO market picked up this summer after three years of doldrums. Shares of stablecoin issuer Circle Internet Group and software maker Figma both soared in their market debuts this year. The government shutdown slowed the pace of new offerings, but bankers and investors are op-

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Unruly Market in Teen Sports Tears a Family Apart

A young wide receiver was shopped around a secret economy for high-school talent; 'My son is going to be a millionaire'

By Harriet Ryan

Phillip Bell III was in tears when he phoned his grandparents' farm outside Sacramento.

"Come and help me please," his grandmother, Lorna Barnes, recalled the then-16-year-old sobbing in March 2023.

Two months earlier, his mother had whisked Bell, a nationally ranked wide receiver, off to a new school in Los Angeles, where they were living in a mansion previously occupied by the rapper Soulja Boy and leased with the help of a sportscaster whose son played quarterback.

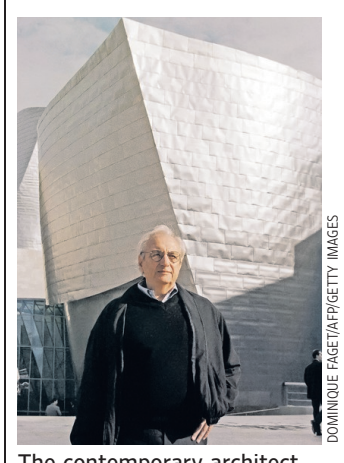
It was just the first stop on Bell's odyssey through the youth sports black market. Paying students to play sports is against state interscholastic rules. But in the nation's football hotbeds, a secret economy in athletically gifted teens has thrived for years—and the recent arrival in most states of legal Name, Image and Likeness compensation for high-school athletes has only made it hotter.

Bell's mother, who abused drugs, shopped him from school to school, demanding up to $72,000 a year, according to court filings, public records and interviews with relatives and others who knew the family.

Bell is now a freshman at top-ranked Ohio State. In the era of NIL compensation, the best college players have essentially become their own businesses, and Bell has the potential to earn millions of dollars in college on his way to an even more lucrative career in

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Frank Gehry Dies at 96



DOMINIQUE FAGET/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

The contemporary architect was hailed for designs that became destinations. **C6**

The Santas Ruining Christmas

* * *

Shortage of giant lawn ornaments sparks panic

By Jennifer Williams

Landon Richard knew something wasn't right back in September.

The 30-year-old in Louisiana is among the real-life Clark Griswolds who begins planning for Christmas early in the year. It starts in March, when Home Depot insiders gather in Las Vegas in part to scope out the retailer's supersize holiday dec-

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EXCHANGE



STATUS SYMBOL
How Arc'teryx is taking over the world with $1,000 jackets. **B1**

Vaccine Panel Nixes Hepatitis B Guidance

By Liz Essley Whyte And Sabrina Siddiqui

A key vaccine panel at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention voted 8-3 to nix a recommendation that all newborns be given a first dose of hepatitis B vaccine.

The Friday vote, which came after the panel heard presentations from vaccine skeptics, does away with guidance that has been in place since 1991. Scientists have credited it with helping drive down rates of hepatitis B infection, which can lead to liver damage, cancer and death.

The Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices, or ACIP, recommended that if an infant's mother tests negative for hepatitis B, parents should consult a doctor about whether the baby needs an early vaccine dose. ACIP also suggested that infants who skip the birth dose shouldn't receive their first dose until they are at least two months of age.

The recommendation from the committee—which was remade by Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. earlier this year after he pushed out all the previous members—must be endorsed by the acting CDC director before it goes into effect.

President Trump praised the committee's move in a social-media post, calling it a "very good decision." He said

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